

THE BOX HOUSE

GOTRI, VADODARA

Plot Area: 4,500 sq ft

Built-up Area: 4,800 sq ft

Project Timeline: 2017 – 2019

Project Cost: INR 4,500 sq ft



TRAANSPLACE, VADODARA

Principal Architect: Urvi Shah

Project Team: Kunjal Shah, Helly Shah, Sanjana Kantawala



The concept of The Box House is unique and adds a character to the design by means of the climate responsive balcony and window seating. The concept of box is taken as a reference for developing the overall design language. A very timeless material palette of brick is conceptualized for this house. The spatial design focuses on the aspect of creating cozy nooks that connect the interior with the exterior. One such space is the window seating, framing the garden from the living room. To sum up, this project is an attempt to strike a balance between the attributes of form, function and nature.

The House is on a plot area of 4500 sq. ft. which is located in a gated community surrounded by bungalows on adjoining sides and access only on the south. The clients wanted the house to be outlined for a family of four. Having lived in a very utilitarian house until now, they desired a shift to a house closer to nature. So the main concept was to open out each space and have green pockets in sync with nature. These green pockets form different axes that visually blur the boundaries between inside and outside and enhance connectivity. The heart of the design is the central courtyard strategically created to establish visual linkages.

On the ground floor, the green pocket is introduced in the form of a central courtyard. The ground floor along with the courtyard comprises other common areas like living, dining, kitchen, and one bedroom. The courtyard continues on the first floor which comprises private areas. On the first floor, three bedrooms are connected with a common reading space overlooking the courtyard. The second floor comprises semi-private spaces like the entertainment room. The second floor extends itself into a beautiful terrace which has a gazebo making the space more interactive by creating a cozy nook for the family members. The central courtyard is highlighted with an umbrella tree.

Further, the slit window and the skylight bring in natural light and cast sciography throughout the day. The courtyard and the garden form a longitudinal axis framing beautiful views for the living area. The courtyard, dining, and the deck form a transverse axis giving dining the experience of being set in the greens.

The dining extends into an outdoor deck and a water body creating a tranquil and zen environment for a sit-out. In the vertical direction, the courtyard exudes different experiences at different levels. In the vertical direction, the courtyard exudes different experiences at different levels.

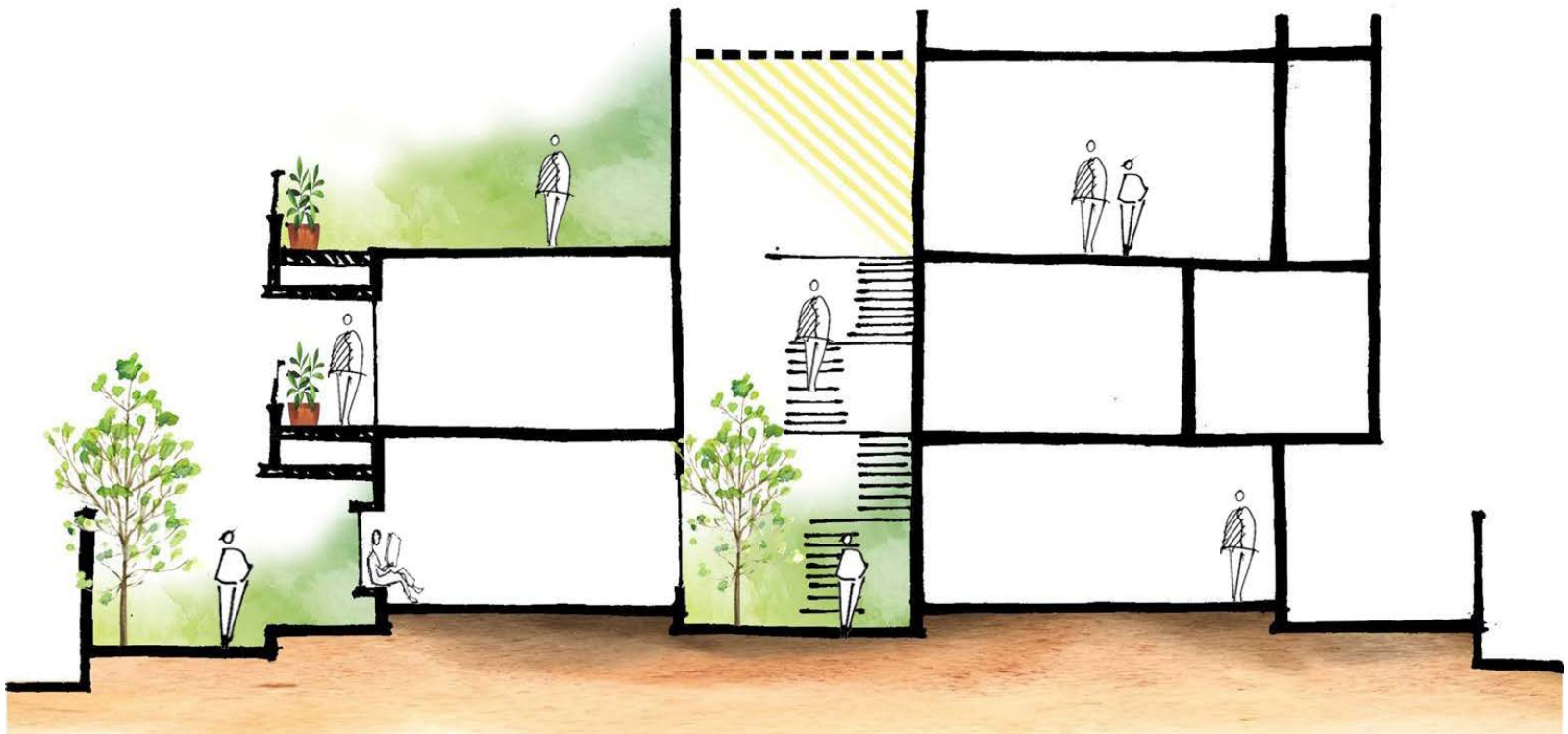
The planning is simple, after leaving the regulation margins; an additional setback was planned on the front. A garden was conceptualized in this expanse. Living, dining, and staircase forming the active core of the house, were designed with limited or no wall separation between them. Aligned to the client's brief, landscaped pockets were planned in and around these spaces along with the central courtyard and the staircase placed in the central courtyard.

The facade is flanked by balconies and terraces at different levels to cut harsh sunlight thus acting as a buffer for the main functional spaces. Boxes are used as an element to add character to these spaces. This concept of boxes is then taken further while developing the overall design language. A timeless material palette of brick and exposed plaster define the exterior.

The interior color scheme is conceptualized to be neutral and the material palette is minimal. All the furniture is handcrafted/customized using wood and metal as the key elements. Used differently against the subtle backdrops of white and grey, these materials are then overlaid with pastel furnishings. The design process finishes with the addition of plants in all the spaces.



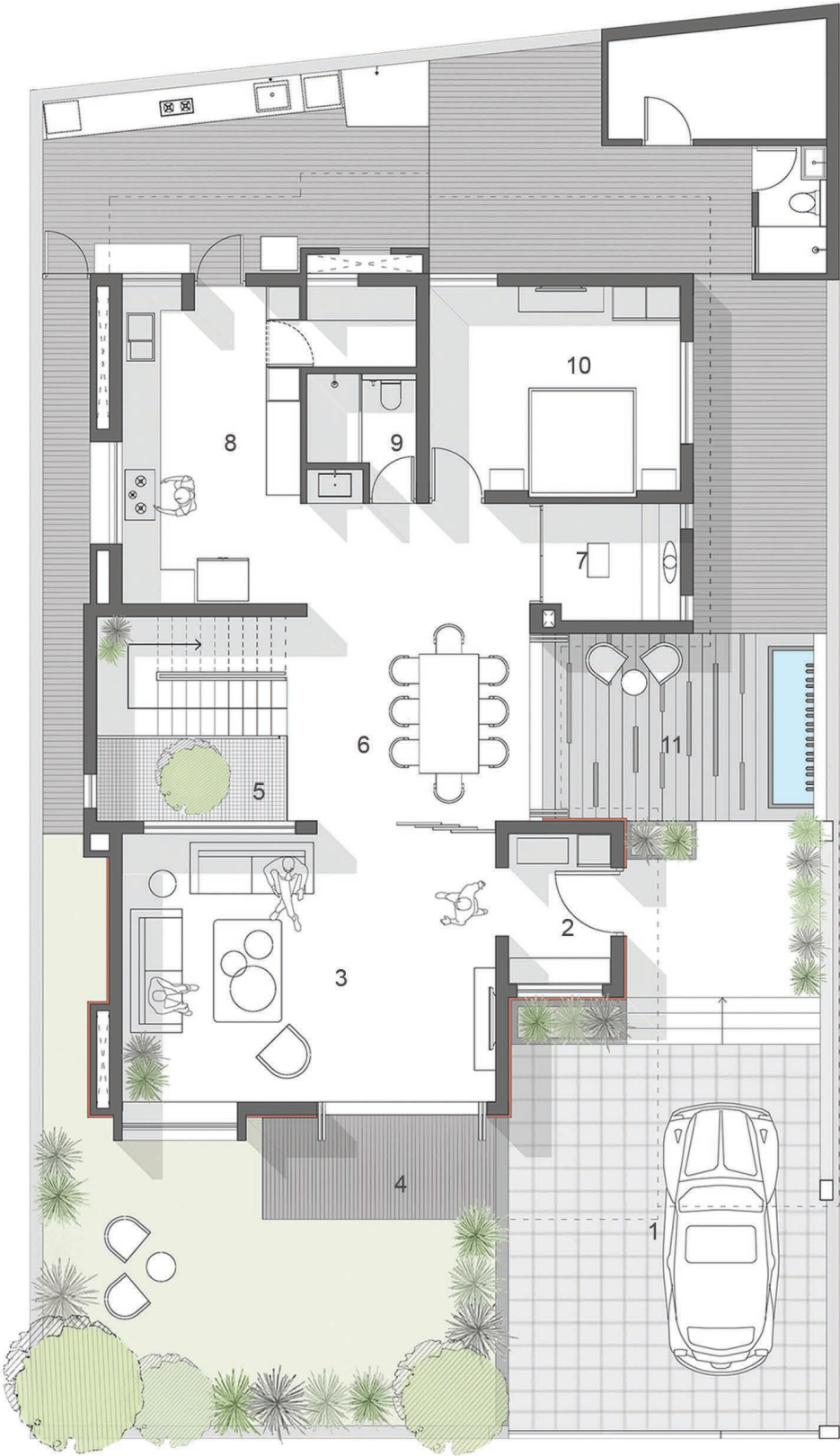
Location



Conceptual Sketch



External Façade



LEGEND

- | | | |
|-----------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. PARKING | 5. COURTYARD | 9. POWDER ROOM |
| 2. FOYER | 6. DINING AREA | 10. BEDROOM |
| 3. LIVING ROOM | 7. PUJA ROOM | 11. OUTDOOR SITTING WITH WATER BODY |
| 4. DECK- GARDEN | 8. KITCHEN | |

Ground Floor Plan



Exterior showing the Box window and the brick clad facade

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Entrance foyer on Ground floor

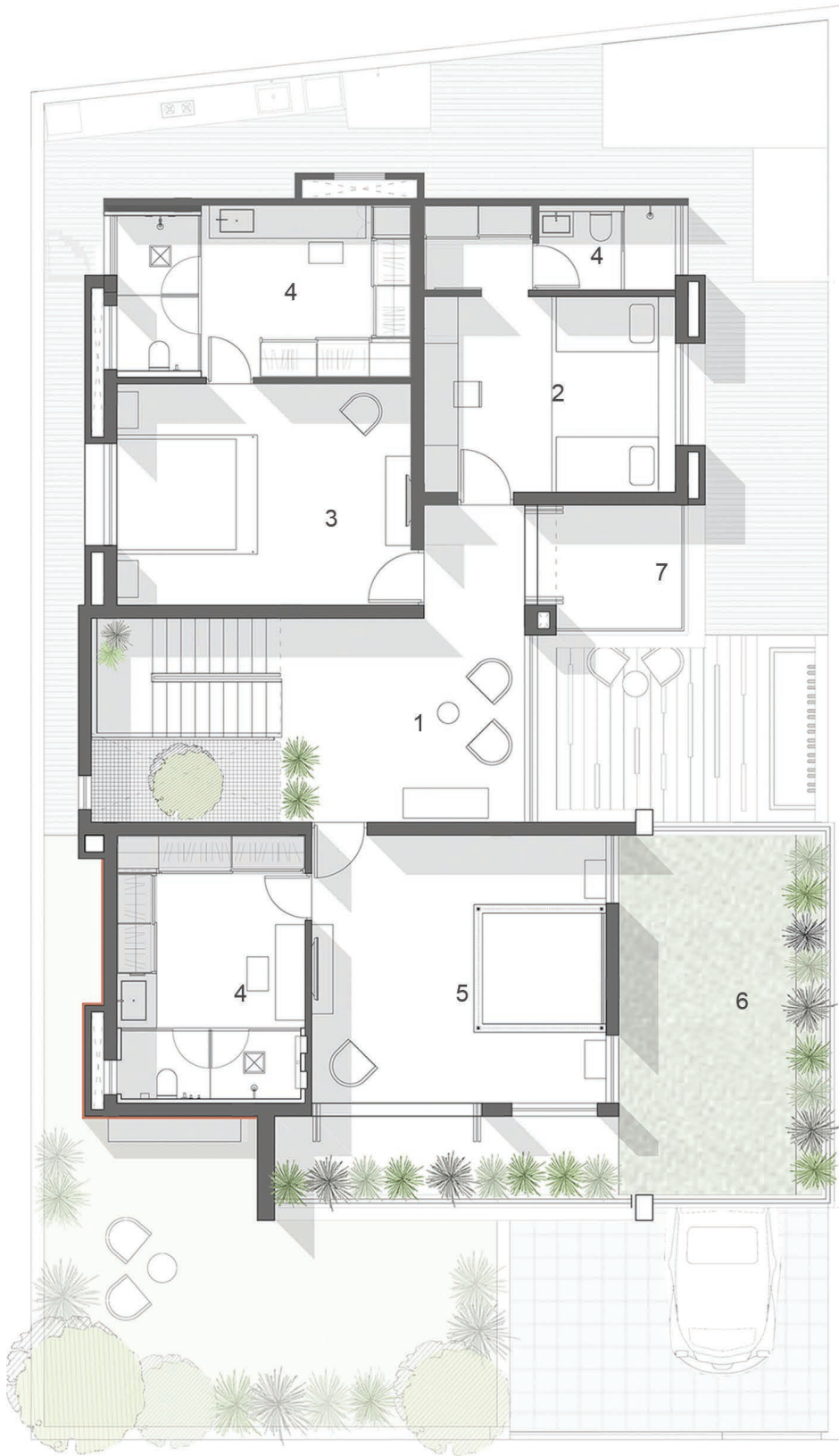


One of the cosy nooks in The Box House – Entrance foyer





The dining, formal living, and staircase area are all well-ventilated and naturally lit through large openings

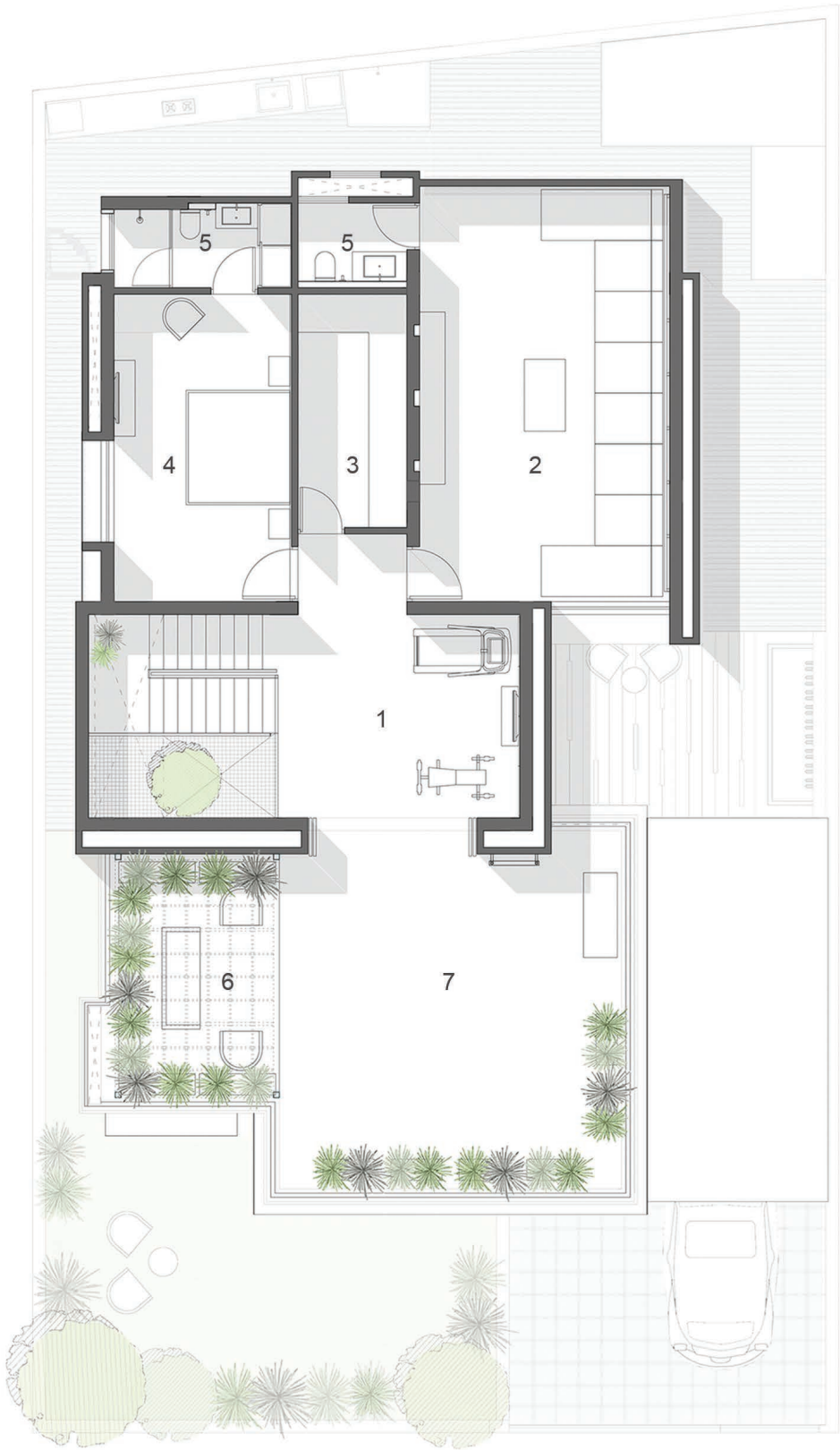


LEGEND

- | | |
|-------------------|---------------------|
| 1. FAMILY SITTING | 5. PARENT'S BEDROOM |
| 2. KID'S BEDROOM | 6. LOWER TERRACE |
| 3. MASTER BEDROOM | 7. BALCONY |
| 4. TOILET | |



First Floor Plan



LEGEND

- 1. GYM
- 2. HOME THEATRE
- 3. STORE
- 4. BEDROOM
- 5. TOILET
- 6. GAZEBO SITTING
- 7. TERRACE



Second Floor Plan



First floor passage



The landing on the first floor doubles out as a reading space



View of the Bedroom



Kids Bedroom - First floor



Home Theatre - Second floor



Terrace- Second floor



Section through Staircase



The steel staircase runs alongside an internal courtyard

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View of the internal courtyard from the staircase





Front Elevation



External facade in exposed brick with exposed concrete extrusions

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A balcony on the first floor overlooks the entrance





Night View of the front facade





The deck with a water feature is an extension of the entrance as well as the dining space

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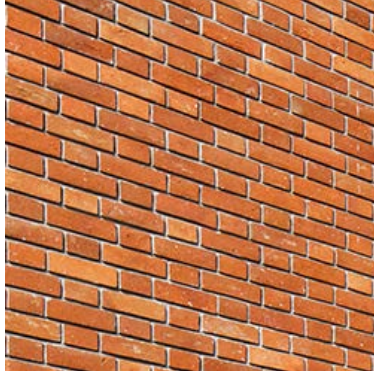
View of the interiors through the Box window





A monochromatic material palette in the reading area is complemented with pops of primary-colored artwork

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UNIQUE MATERIAL APPLICATIONS

Bricks: JJB from The Brick Store

Windows: Aluminium Windows

Marble: Grey Burberry from Akash Marble

Lighting: Hybec Perfect Lights

Color: ICICI, Dulux

Sanitaryware/Bath Fittings: Kohler from The Bath World

Furniture: Demodes

Furnishing: D'Décor from Demodes

Hardware: Hettich from Smit Enterprise

Veneer: Royal Teak Veneer from Smit Enterprise

Laminates: Timex from Smit Enterprise

Wooden Flooring: Vir Interior

Air Conditioning: Daikin from AdvanceTech

KEY CONTRIBUTORS

Civil: Bhadresh

Landscape: Traanspace

MEP: Traanspace

HVAC: AdvanceTech

Acoustics: Asmi Consultants

PHOTO CREDITS

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